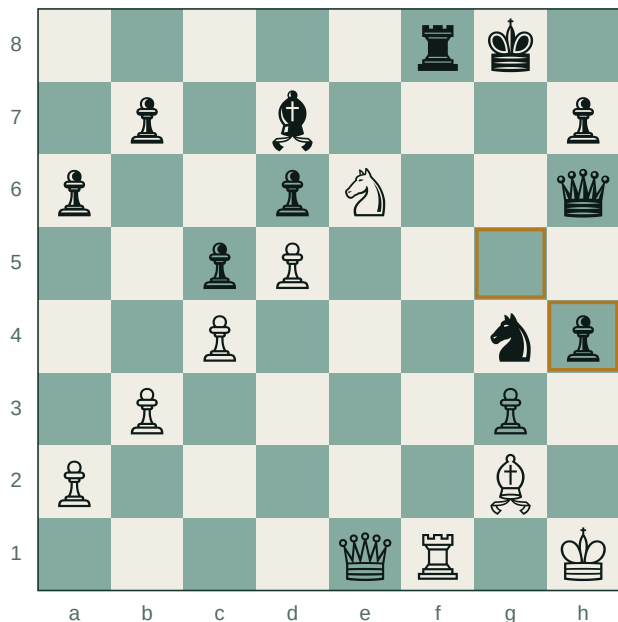


Kingside attacks: White, move 31

Kingside attacks

White to move



Previous move: 30...gxh4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31. Rxf8+ Qxf8 32. Nxf8

31.Rxf8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on f8. Recorded reply: **31...Qxf8**.

32.Nxf8 The knight captures the queen on f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 20 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -1 to +8. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d7 and knight on g4. Check for tactical protection.